

Facebook trumps Yahoo!

Facebook has surpassed Yahoo! to emerge as the second largest traffic source for videos on media sites

Replacing fiber optics

DARPA and Raytheon are developing free-space photon networks to replace fibre optics

nied by a very good interface with filters that out do those of eBay. While searching for a phone, we could even select one on basis of operating system. Add to this the crowning glory of the site, cash-on-delivery, perhaps the safest payment mode known to webkind. But, they still don't allow you to open the product, do they? So that is just half of the problem solved. Maybe we are just being paranoid. To conclude, all things considered, all scored evaluated, the winner of Tech-shopping – Consumer Tech category is definitely Infibeam.com.

Tech components

In this category we looked at web sites that specialise in IT hardware components. Like we said earlier, these are things that go inside a PC – processors, motherboards... that kind of stuff. Web sites shortlisted for this test included sites such as TheITwares, Mediahome.in, Tech-Shop.in and many more. While some of these web sites do offer products that fall under the domain of general Consumer Tech, that wasn't their prime focus area.

When going about this comparison we focused on key criteria based on the pattern in which people shop – settle on a budget, make the best possible config, go out (or online) and check if those exact components are available, then buy. Depending on availability, you will then modify your config to the best possible one considering availability. A good web site, hence, should be one that can give you all your desired compo-

nents in one place, at one go. If you have to go from pillar to post and order 12 different components from 12 different web sites, it makes no sense considering the multiple shipping charges. Therefore we gave a lot of importance and weightage to availability. Next in priority was price. We took a random sample of a few products and compared prices across the board. The web site with the least expensive products got a better score. Now let's get down to some of the things that emerged while testing...

Remember Deltapage? The page earlier

used to have just a very frequently updated listing of components and their market prices. Now redirecting to the shop first, the web site shows a decent quantum of products. The theITwares.in and theITdepot.com had a good user interface and scored high in ease of discovery thanks to their filters. Once in the main category, theITdepot.com even had check boxes to narrow down by parameters such as clock speed in case of processor. MediaHome had some hard to acquire and "famous-on-forums" type of products such as Biostar Graphics cards at very inexpensive prices, but the overall variety was not very good. TheITdepot had the largest range of graphics cards. Lynx-India.com and Techshop.in were strictly OK in terms of overall range and price, but at the same time had some fantastic deals on some products.

Another contender, Primeabgb had a reasonably large range of products (though not as much as TheITDepot) and festive offers. But the web site had some weird categorisation. For instance, "Belking Products" showing up in between categories like Graphic Cards, DVD Burners etc.

Finally to conclude, after looking at overall ratings in the light of weights that we assigned, theitdepot.com emerged as the winner, thanks to its wide range of products in each category, ease of search and navigation, and the visual appeal. The prices were one factor were it lost to some by a little but not by a lot.

What you said...



Sourav Choudhary Depends On from where I am purchasing! Purchasing online is good and I have done it a dozen times in the past but then too I don't trust it fully! :(



Tafzal Shaikh I guess more % of people used online e-commerce as price comparing tool & free preview with technical features for actual ground product :P



Krishnandu Sarkar As for me, I'm not scared, but shopping really depends on the deals. I bought many items, even books online as they holds best prices there, even after including the shipping charge. And some items were lower on local shops. So for me it depends on the price and deal.



Jesin A Jesin Many people are too scared to give away their debit/credit card numbers online. They don't even wish to learn how the online payment process works. They just hear stories of how money was stolen from Mr. X online and they don't see the details either, all they can think of is "money stolen" and "online"

THE IT DEPOT

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Play to dominate with a gaming-grade mouse that delivers extreme response and unprecedented control.

₹ 1496 ₹ 1445

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Avermedia DarkCrystal HD Capture Station (CB74) Pass through Content while Recording, IR Blaster and Scheduled Recording.

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Products - 0

Quantity - 0